

AI & Automation Grants in Estonia 2026

All main EIS programmes for AI, automation and digitalisation on one page — in plain language.
Verified May 2026.

Grant	Up to	Who it fits	First step
Digitalisation Roadmap EIS	€10,000 50–70% covered	SMEs with ≥ €200K average revenue over the last 2 years.	Pick a consultant from EIS ‘Good Practice’ list and write a 3-year digital roadmap with them.
Digital Transformation EIS	€35,000 30–50% own funds	Companies that already have an EIS-approved roadmap and want to implement AI / automation / software from it.	First complete the roadmap (above). Then apply with a concrete implementation project.
Innovation Voucher EIS · Innovatsiooniosak	€7,500	SMEs exploring a new R&D idea: feasibility studies, tech analysis, pilots.	Find a research partner (university or R&D centre). Define one focused study you want to buy from them.
Development Voucher EIS · Arendusosak	€35,000	SMEs building a working MVP or a development project, possibly hiring a specialist.	Define a concrete development project with a measurable result, then apply.
Applied Research Programme (RUP) EIS	€250K – €2M	Larger R&D projects — including AI products and platforms.	Pre-consult with EIS by 3 Aug 2026 (mandatory). Round runs 3 Aug – 28 Sep 2026.
AIRE Demo Project EDIH · partner of EIS	€60,000	Estonian manufacturers piloting AI or robotics solutions (test before invest).	Submit an idea to the AIRE ‘Call for ideas’. Relaunched in updated form Q1 2026.

How to choose in 60 seconds

Not sure where to start? Begin with the Digitalisation Roadmap (€10K). It maps your bottlenecks and unlocks the €35K Digital Transformation grant. Plan the two as a pair.

Have a specific R&D idea? Pick the Innovation Voucher (€7.5K) for a quick feasibility study, or the Development Voucher (€35K) if you already know what to build.

You make physical products? Look at AIRE Demo (€60K) — designed for manufacturers testing AI & robotics.

Bigger ambition? Applied Research (RUP) funds €250K–€2M projects. It is harder to win and needs a clear R&D plan, but the ceiling is high.

Almost every grant requires:

Active company in the Estonian Business Register · no tax debt · clear project plan · co-financing share · usually de minimis aid headroom (under €300K over 3 years).

Sources & current terms: eis.ee · aire-edih.eu. Always re-check the latest round terms before applying — dates and percentages change between rounds.